

Cat behavior decoder covering body language, trust-building, and understanding feline affection styles — Action Checklist

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READ YOUR CAT'S BODY LANGUAGE

- ☐ **Observe your cat's tail for five minutes daily over three days without interacting so you can collect real data on their emotional baseline and patterns.:** Observe your cat's tail for five minutes daily over three days without interacting so you can collect real data on their emotional baseline and patterns.
- ☐ **Learn to distinguish all five tail positions—high, question-mark curve, puffed, tucked, and low/stiff—and notice what circumstances trigger each one.:** Learn to distinguish all five tail positions—high, question-mark curve, puffed, tucked, and low/stiff—and notice what circumstances trigger each one.
- ☐ **Identify the exact body language cues your cat shows in the minutes before they bite or scratch you so you can stop missing the warnings.:** Identify the exact body language cues your cat shows in the minutes before they bite or scratch you so you can stop missing the warnings.
- ☐ **Recognize when a slow blink means genuine affection versus when your cat is quietly asking you to give them more space right now.:** Recognize when a slow blink means genuine affection versus when your cat is quietly asking you to give them more space right now.

UNDERSTAND YOUR CAT'S AFFECTION STYLE

- ☐ **Mirror the slow blink back to your cat during calm moments as a deliberate trust-building signal that communicates you are not a threat.:** Mirror the slow blink back to your cat during calm moments as a deliberate trust-building signal that communicates you are not a threat.
 - ☐ **Stop taking your cat's rejection personally by understanding that avoidance is about safety signals, not a judgment of your worth as an owner.:** Stop taking your cat's rejection personally by understanding that avoidance is about safety signals, not a judgment of your worth as an owner.
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- ☐ **Accept that cats show affection on their own timeline based on their comfort level, which means patience is not optional but essential.:** Accept that cats show affection on their own timeline based on their comfort level, which means patience is not optional but essential.
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- ☐ **Give your cat space immediately when you see a puffed tail or a lashing tail to prevent fear-based aggression from escalating further.:** Give your cat space immediately when you see a puffed tail or a lashing tail to prevent fear-based aggression from escalating further.

BUILD TRUST THROUGH DAILY ACTIONS

- ☐ **Use calm, slow movements when you enter a room where your cat is resting so you do not accidentally trigger a defensive response.:** Use calm, slow movements when you enter a room where your cat is resting so you do not accidentally trigger a defensive response.
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- ☐ **Spend time in the same room as your cat without demanding interaction every day so proximity becomes associated with safety rather than pressure.:** Spend time in the same room as your cat without demanding interaction every day so proximity becomes associated with safety rather than pressure.
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- ☐ **Log the specific situations that trigger biting or scratching episodes so you can identify patterns and avoid repeating those mistakes.:** Log the specific situations that trigger biting or scratching episodes so you can identify patterns and avoid repeating those mistakes.
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- ☐ **Work on decoding your cat's signals before you try to change their behavior because they are already communicating what they need.:** Work on decoding your cat's signals before you try to change their behavior because they are already communicating what they need.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.